CLASS 9 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 7: **Carrier of Words; Words (poem)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The paradox 'a few words can say more than a thousand' means: 1

(a) brief, sincere words can carry great meaning
(b) numbers matter
(c) long speeches are best
(d) silence is empty

2. Choose the correct reported speech: He said, 'Had I known, I would have come earlier.' 1

(a) He said he knows and came.
(b) He said that had he known, he would have come earlier.
(c) He said I had known I would come.
(d) He said had I known.

3. What is implied by saying a letter can be a 'lifeline'? 1

(a) it is a rope
(b) it is decoration
(c) it can sustain emotional and economic survival
(d) it is a toy

4. The relationship between 'carrier' and 'word' in the unit is: 1

(a) the carrier is unimportant
(b) the quality of the message depends on the carrier and the content
(c) the word is unimportant
(d) neither matters

5. Which expression best describes Khetaram: 'a tower of strength'? 1

(a) a tall man **(b)** a source of support
(c) a rich man **(d)** a building

6. What does the postman's reading of letters reveal about literacy in the village? 1

(a) gaps in access to education **(b)** great learning
(c) good schools **(d)** no interest

7. Which statement links the two pieces? 1

(a) Postmen write poems
(b) Communication is a moral act as well as a practical one
(c) Deserts need rain
(d) Words are cheap

8. 'Ephemeral' is a good word to describe: 1

(a) a stone **(b)** a sacred book
(c) a mountain **(d)** a fleeting spoken word

9. Which description captures the ethics of Khetaram's work? 1

(a) speed and show **(b)** cunning
(c) confidentiality and fidelity **(d)** fame and fortune

10. Which reading of the poem is least supported? 1

(a) Words can hurt **(b)** Words are harmless
(c) Words can heal **(d)** Words should be chosen with care

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How does the poem use brevity to enhance its message? 2

12. How are responsibility and power linked in the poem? 2

13. Discuss how trust is built and risked in Khetaram's role. 2

14. Explain how a poem about words is itself an example of choosing words. 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Does the chapter depict dependence as strength or weakness? Argue. 3

16. Evaluate the poem's use of simple language to deliver a complex idea. 3

17. Explain the effect of the metaphor 'words are seeds'. 3

OR

How does the writer connect personal stories with national institutions? 3

18. Explain how a poem on words can also be about silence. 3

OR

Compare how the chapter and the poem treat the idea of responsibility. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Examine how the writer uses specific details to make an abstract idea concrete. 5

OR

Write a letter to the editor urging better facilities for rural postal workers. 5

20. Write an essay (about 150 words) on 'The unseen heroes of society'. 5

OR

Write a short story (about 120 words) of a letter that arrives after many years. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks